

ChurchFlow Admin

Digital church administration system

Feature brief

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A connected operating system for church leaders, departments, and members

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1 Executive summary

ChurchFlow Admin is a unified digital system for managing the operational, financial, pastoral, and communication needs of a church. It combines a leader command center with a mobile-first member experience so that church teams can coordinate people, services, giving, projects, events, care, and ministry content in one place.

The system is designed around a simple principle: **administration should make care easier, not make ministry feel bureaucratic**. Leaders receive clear operational visibility, while members can respond to services, review their participation, give toward projects, receive updates, submit prayer requests, share testimonies, and access sermon content.

2 Product at a glance

Area	Primary users	Outcome
Church operations	Pastors, administrators	One view of church health
Member engagement	Members, visitors	Simple participation and self-service
Finance and projects	Finance teams, project leaders	Transparent giving and progress
Care and follow-up	Care teams, department leaders	Timely pastoral response
Message distribution	Communications teams	Consistent email and WhatsApp updates
Sermon media	Preachers, media teams	Transcripts and shareable highlights

3 Leader command center

The leader workspace provides a persistent, responsive administration dashboard with a deep-navy navigation rail and calm operational cards. It surfaces the metrics and follow-up actions that matter most at the start of a church week.

- **Overview dashboard:** total members, Sunday attendance, giving activity, follow-up queue, attendance trend, upcoming events, people needing attention, and recent activity.
- **People and membership:** member lists, visitor follow-up, member status, departments, roles, contact details, and communication preferences.
- **Attendance management:** service attendance declarations, online versus in-person responses, service-day reminders, and attendance history.
- **Giving management:** giving activity, contribution records, project contributions, payment references, and member giving history.

- **Events and departments:** upcoming services, leadership gatherings, outreach, ministry teams, rosters, and department communication.
- **Care inbox:** one place for prayer requests and testimonies submitted through the member experience. The dashboard uses clear states and action-oriented controls so leaders can move from insight to follow-up without leaving the workspace.

4 Member experience

The member portal is a mobile-first, installable web experience designed for frequent, low-friction participation. It gives members a personal view of their relationship with the church and avoids exposing sensitive information belonging to other members.

4.1 Participation and history

Members can declare whether they are attending a service in person, joining online, or not attending. They can review attendance history and giving history, giving them a reliable record of past participation.

4.2 Notifications and reminders

The notification center brings together personalized messages, event reminders, giving updates, care follow-up, and system notices from church leaders. Notifications are designed to support action without overwhelming the member.

4.3 Prayer and testimony

Members can submit prayer requests directly from their dashboard, choose private care handling, and track the status of their request. Members can also write testimonies and explicitly control whether a testimony may be shared. Submissions appear in the leader care inbox for review and follow-up.

4.4 Installable member app

The member portal includes installable web-app metadata and a lightweight service worker so members can keep ChurchFlow close to their home screen and return quickly to attendance, giving, notifications, and care actions.

5 Giving, projects, and contribution progress

ChurchFlow supports both general giving visibility and goal-based contribution projects. A leader can create, edit, archive, and delete projects, define a target amount and deadline, add a payment link, and see progress toward the target.

Project progress is represented with clear visual bars and contribution summaries. Members can open the project payment link from the member experience, while leaders can track contributions and references. This makes fundraising more transparent and helps the congregation see what collective giving is making possible.

The system is structured to support future giving statements, receipt downloads, exportable reports, and payment-provider integrations without storing payment credentials in the application database.

6 Communications and coordination

The communications workspace supports targeted messages to active members, departments, leaders, or event audiences. A campaign can include a title, message body, audience, channel, payment link, and optional scheduled time.

Supported channel choices are:

- **Email only** for formal updates, receipts, teaching notes, and longer messages.
- **WhatsApp only** for concise reminders and high-engagement service communication.
- **Email and WhatsApp** for important updates that deserve both reach and persistence.

The communication model records consent preferences, creator, audience, schedule, sent state, and optional links. If a provider is not configured, the system should show a safe draft or queued state rather than implying that a message was delivered.

7 Sermon recording and highlight workflow

The Sermons workspace turns a preaching recording into reusable ministry content.

1. A leader enters the sermon title, preacher, and service date.
2. The browser captures audio through the MediaRecorder API with visible recording and stop controls.
3. The leader can optionally add a video URL or upload a video file. Video is never required for transcription.
4. Audio is stored securely outside the database and sent to the built-in speech-to-text service through a signed media URL.
5. ChurchFlow saves the transcript and extracts concise highlights from timestamped transcript segments.
6. The leader reviews the transcript and highlights before sharing.
7. Highlights can be queued for email, WhatsApp, or both channels, with a link to the full message where available.
8. Saved sermons appear in a library with status indicators such as recorded, ready, or distributed.

The audio transcription path enforces a 16 MB audio limit and handles microphone denial, missing audio, storage failures, and transcription errors with user-facing feedback. Optional video uploads are limited separately and stored as media references rather than database blobs.

8 Privacy, roles, and safety

The application distinguishes between authenticated members and authorized leaders. Member procedures are protected, and administrative review procedures are restricted to leader/admin roles.

Sensitive ministry data receives explicit safeguards:

- Prayer requests are private by default.
- Testimony sharing permission is separate from testimony submission status.
- Care records are not placed in public feeds.
- Media bytes are stored in object storage; the database stores references.
- Communication channels respect member opt-in preferences.
- Timestamps are stored in UTC and localized for display.
- Destructive actions should be reversible or clearly confirmed.

9 Technical foundation

The current implementation uses a React 19 frontend, Tailwind-based styling, Express, tRPC for typed procedures, Drizzle ORM with MySQL/TiDB-compatible schema definitions, managed object storage, Manus OAuth, and the built-in transcription service.

The product includes focused Vitest coverage for communication links, church metrics, sermon highlight extraction, and authentication behavior. The project has been validated with TypeScript checks, production builds, database migrations, and responsive preview checks.

10 Suggested next additions

The strongest next steps are to connect real email and WhatsApp providers, add downloadable giving statements and receipts, add searchable transcript indexing, and introduce department-level permissions. A later phase could add speaker labels, sermon chapter markers, recurring attendance reminders, visitor onboarding sequences, and a finance export suitable for the church treasurer.

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